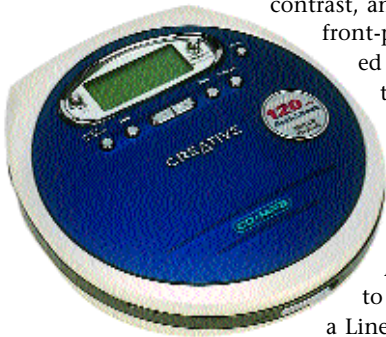


Creative DAP CD0001

The Creative DAP CD0001 is a CD-based MP3 player. To enjoy music on this unit, you will need to copy your MP3 audio collection to a CD. The fact that this unit can also play normal audio CDs is an attractive bonus. The unit is reasonably compact, easy on the eyes with its good colour contrast, and has a matte-finished front-panel with chrome-plated buttons. Rubber feet on the base prevent the player from slipping off tables while a good build quality ensures that the unit can take a couple of nasty falls. All in all, it is a chic unit to sport around. It also has a Line Out port that lets you connect the player to your home audio system. The bundled DC-adaptor lets you run the unit even when it is out of battery. The DAP has a comfortably large LCD display and built-in support for ID3 tags, enabling you to identify the name of the song that is playing. As a CD-based unit, this player needs some sort of anti-shock protection, to prevent songs from skipping. It has a 120 second anti-skip buffer that does just that. The DAP also comes with a useful remote control unit, and has a sufficiently long cable for both the remote and the earphones that are bundled along with it. Great features combined with an excellent showing in our test runs and an affordable price of Rs 8,625 made this the clear overall winner in our line-up.



Creative DAP CD0001		A-
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Ease of use	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Warranty & support	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶	

and had the most easy-to-understand menu navigation with all the important features placed within two clicks. As far as portability goes, the Creative PA-20 and the D-Link DMP-100 are unbeatable because of their diminutive size and light weight.

Performance

Although features are important while buying an MP3 player, its performance under different conditions is equally critical. The audio quality it offers, as determined by the frequency response (ranging from bass to treble) and the purity of output are some of the things that we tested to evaluate the contenders.

Audio quality: Each MP3 player was tested using five different audio tracks. These tracks presented a picture of whether the player is perfectly balanced in the low, mid and high tones and whether the bundled earphones cause signal losses in any of these areas. The Philips eXp401 and the Creative PA-20 both came up with top scores. The Philips unit gave the best result in the bass test (it scored 4 points) with no distortion and the

1//2 page ver AD